

SNIPPETS

Reliance launches GSM mobile service

Reliance Communications has launched its nationwide GSM mobile telephone services in India, spread over 11,000 towns and 340,000 villages. With a capital infusion of Rs 100 billion, the project has been completed six months ahead of the schedule, said chairman Anil Ambani, while launching the services from the Reliance Centre in Mumbai.

Dish TV to beam 450 channels

Dish TV is on course to augment channel capacity to 450. At present, it beams 225 channels. This is being done with an aim to boost customer base by giving depth and width of content. According to Dish TV COO Salil Kapoor, Dish TV's subscriber base will soon touch 5-million mark.

Videocon expects slow growth in first half

Videocon Industries expects the slowdown to impact its growth in the first half of the year leading to 12 per cent growth against the earlier 20 per cent target. The company aims to grow its overseas business more than three-fold in the next three years by offering new products to achieve sales of \$1 billion.

Moser Baer's thin-film line ready for production

Moser Baer's photovoltaic subsidiary is ready for production of thin-film photovoltaic modules at its manufacturing plant in Greater Noida. This follows final acceptance test certification of Moser Baer Photovoltaic's SunFab thin-film line supplied by Applied Materials, Inc., the California-based nano-manufacturing technology solutions provider. The certification verifies that the SunFab line has met all manufacturing, module efficiency and yield specifications.

Delta Electronics postpones investment

Delta Electronics has suspended its plan to invest about \$50 million to build a new factory in Chennai. The company also plans to downsize the local manufacturing base in Thailand, currently employing 10,000 people, on expectations of weaker sales performance next year.

Samsung reorganises

Samsung Electronics has reorganised itself into two major groups, joining together its chip and display units and combining the telecom and media businesses. Samsung, the world's biggest maker of memory chips and LCD screens, is struggling as chronic oversupply and falling consumer demand have wiped out profits from the two flagship units.

Motorola to dose sales unit

Motorola, the second-biggest US seller of mobile phones, is shutting down its distribution division as the economic slump erodes consumer spending and demand. The distribution work will now be done out of Singapore. Motorola will cut 4000 more jobs in 2009, in addition to 3000 it announced last year. It is outpacing these employees to other handset companies as well as telecom operators.

Solar boom is over

Bringing an end to eight consecutive years of growth, the global revenue for photovoltaic (PV) panels is expected to drop by nearly 20 per cent in 2009, as a massive oversupply causes prices to decline. Worldwide revenue from shipments of panels will decline to Rs 645 billion in 2009, down 19.1 per cent from that in 2008, according to ISuppli Corp. A drop of this magnitude has not occurred in the last ten years.

IT curriculum developed by Microsoft for students of classes VI through X; as well as a joint certification for higher education students after completion of the MS Digital Literacy curriculum.

Outlook is positive for health care, wireless

While almost all segments of the electronics industry will be flat or decline in 2009, a few exceptions are possible, according to an industry survey. ABI Research predicts that two electronics markets will continue to grow explosively next year: video surveillance and telepresence. Both are expanding rapidly, especially in the Internet protocol sectors. The markets for IP cameras and remote medical diagnostics equipment will continue to expand in 2009, the market researcher predicted.

LG joins hands with Norway's REC Wafer

LG Electronics has entered into an exclusive agreement with solar energy company REC Wafer of Norway to purchase multicrystalline silicon wafers. The agreement is structured as a five-year contract with pre-determined prices of more than \$340 million for the entire contract period.

LG will begin to receive wafers with limited volumes in 2010 and the delivery amount will increase over the contract period until 2014.

"We are committed to investing in and developing clean energy solutions by fully leveraging our cumulative R&D knowledge and mass-manufacturing expertise," said Dr Woo Paik, president and chief technology officer, LG Electronics.

LG Electronics sees solar energy as a new growth engine for the company and has even established a solar cell business team under its CTO. The company is also making investments in solar energy research and development.